

Service Design:
Unique experience at Ajanta Caves

THE PROJECT

Redesigning the services at Ajanta Caves for a better experience, leveraging on the advantages of IT and infrastructure support




TOILET
ASI OFFICE CUM TICKET COUNTER
PORTER
SHUTTLE SERVICES
LOWER VIEW POINT
WAGHORA RIVER
WAGHORA RIVER
FOREST GARDEN
1
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29
30
SHUTTLE SERVICES

BEFORE REACHING THE AJANTA CAVES

JOURNEY TILL AURANGABAD & FARDAPUR



- Travel by air/ train/ bus
- Ask for direction/ use google maps
- Refer to guide books/ websites
- Aurangabad to Fardapur takes 2 hrs
- Social Media/ Blogs, etc

AT AJANTA FOOTHILLS



- Procuring tickets for amenities/ entry/ bus ride
- Shopping activity/ food/ ATMs
- Ajanta Visitors Centre
- Social Media

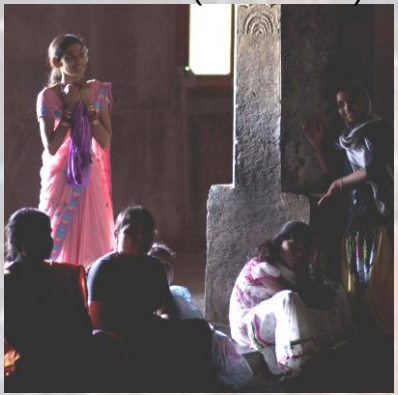
BUS-RIDE FROM THE FOOTHILLS TILL THE CAVES



- A 10 min bus-ride.
- An essential part of the entire journey
- Social Media

AT THE AJANTA CAVES

ENTRANCE TO THE LINE OF CAVES (Cave No.1)



- Tourists hire services like porters till the caves

- Once they reach the caves, they have an option of hiring a guide.

- Signage points to Cave 1, Toilets, Drinking Water, etc

- Social Media

VISIT TO EACH CAVE (2 km approx.)



- As food is not allowed inside the Caves, visitors need to work with whatever food they get at the start of the climb or at the foothills.

- Drinking water is available in 3 places

- Tired tourists tend to abandon the journey halfway through.

- Social Media

AFTER LEAVING THE AJANTA CAVES

RETURN BUS-RIDE



• People are generally very tired by this time and tend to sleep off in the bus.

• Some enthusiasts contemplate on what they saw in the caves and exchange of experiences face-to-face amongst each other.

• Social Media

RETURN JOURNEY

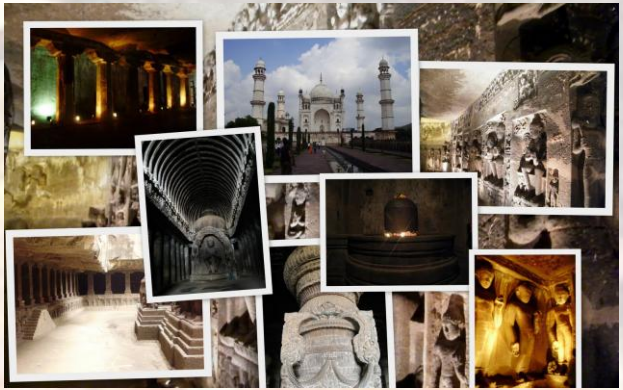


• Sharing of experience amongst each other or fellow travellers.

• Retrospection about the Ajanta Caves

• Social Media

RE-CALL OF THE EXPERIENCE



• Sharing of experience. Retrospective Narration of the visit

• Reviewing their visit.

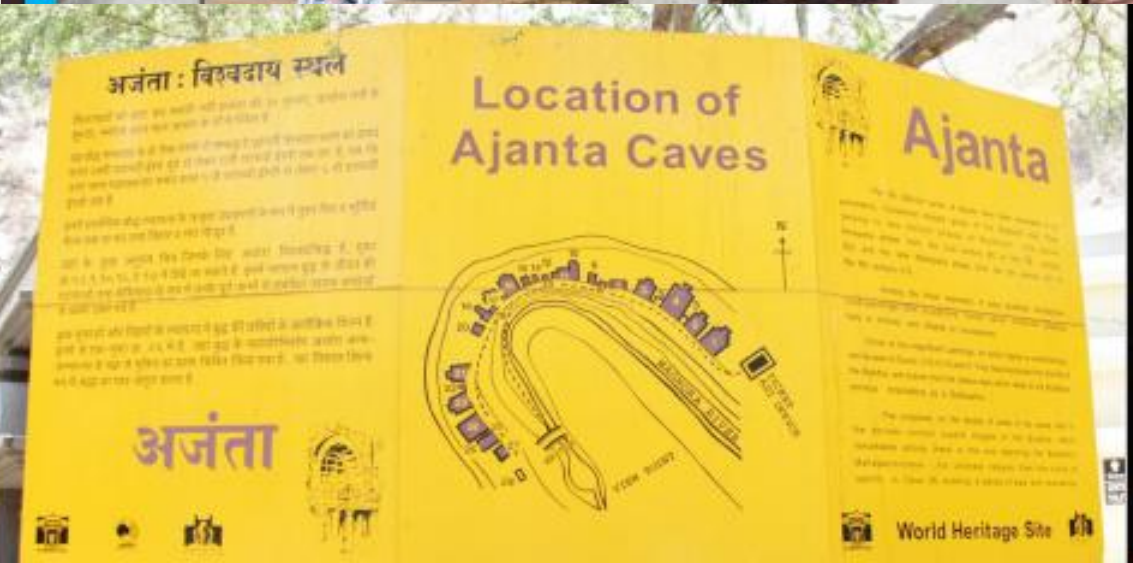
• Re-call of the experience by looking at photos/ videos, etc.

• Remembrance

• Social Media


शॉपिंग प्लाझा SHOPPING PLAZA

1


अजंता : विश्वदाय स्थल
Location of Ajanta Caves
Ajanta
अजंता
World Heritage Site



7

SERVICES AT AJANTA CAVES

Ajanta Visitors Centre- A Ministry of Tourism Project

It houses:

•**Info-graphic Panels:** There are a number of panels showing the advent of Buddhism in India, the culture, the paintings, on a timeline. (audio clues)

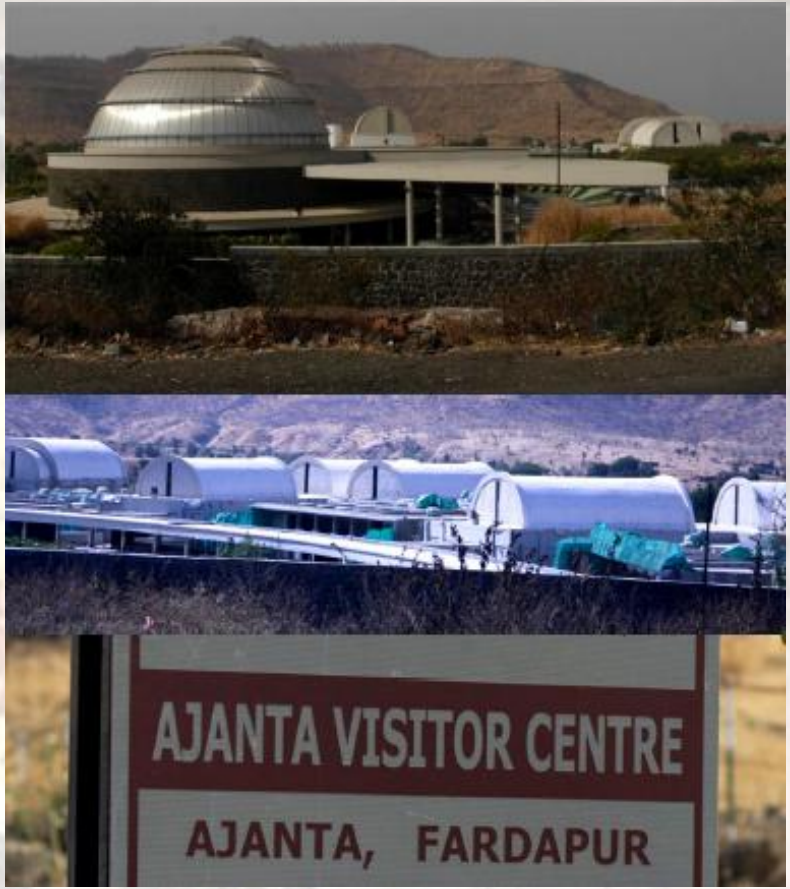
•**Maps:** Maps showing the formation of cave structure and each cave.

•**Narrative Movies (8mins):** These movies would be run on projectors placed all around the centre.

•**Interactive Screens:** There screens have a navigation interface and also talk about the paintings and can generate visual walkthroughs for the users

•**Sculptures:** These show the various Mudras and Postures of Buddha.

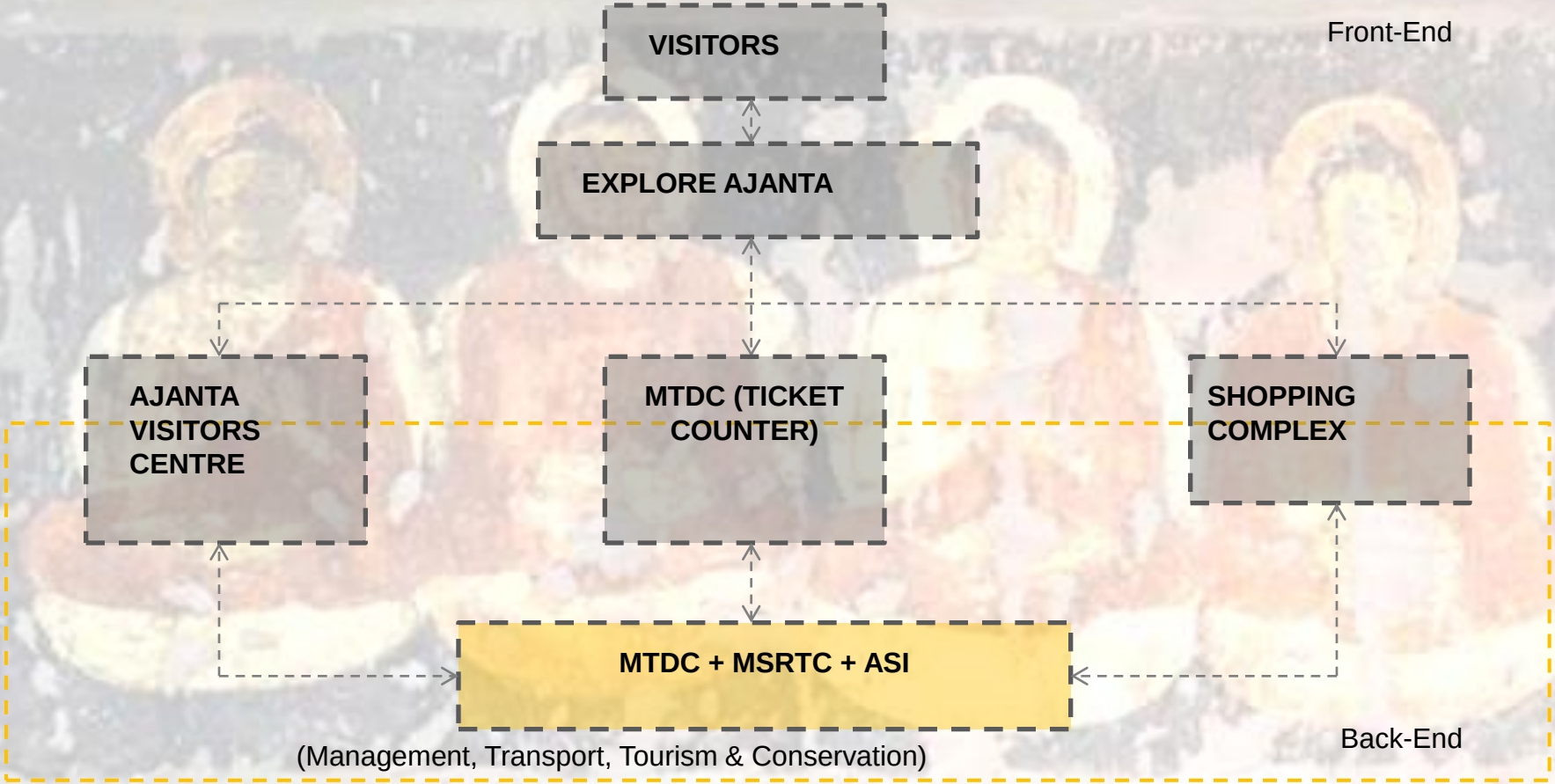
•**Cave Replicas:** Cave 1,2, 16 & 17 have been totally replicated here with flex printout of the existing paintings.



THE SYSTEM- redesigned

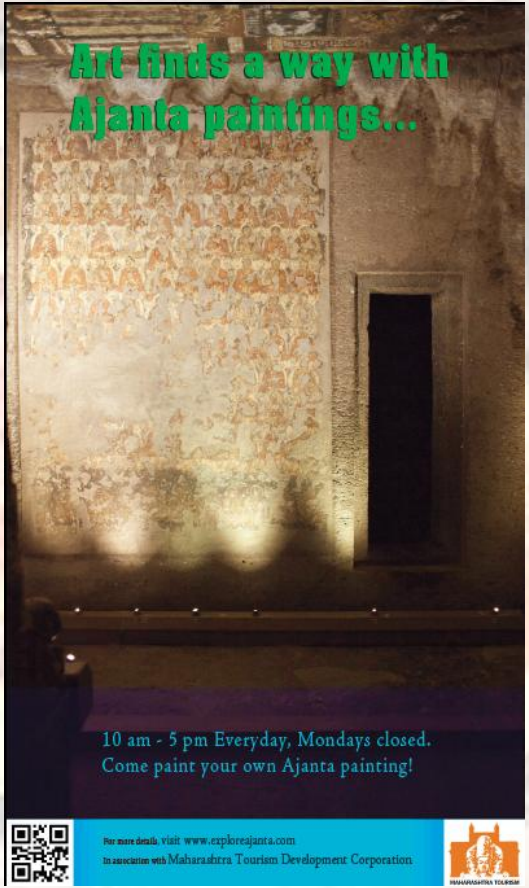
	Before a visitor reaches Ajanta	During the visit- at Ajanta	After completion of the visit
FRONT END	*Website: www.exploreajanta.com* Information on Ajanta Services available at Ajanta Registration -Tourists can look up information -Tourists can pre-book their interactive devices -Seats for the light-and-sound show	*The Bus Ride* The ride is utilized in giving out information- like a prequel. This adds to visitors' anticipation and sets correct expectations. *Light-and-sound show* Shows arranged on certain days of the month. Interactive devices and displays	*Website: www.exploreajanta.com* -The content is saved to each visitors' profile. -Visitor can access the data till a period of 3 months -Visitors can link their social media profiles to their footprints -Visitors can blog about their visit to Ajanta
BACK END	*Website: www.exploreajanta.com* -Linked to travel websites and travel bookings -Connected through MTDC bookings/ hotels around Aurangabad/ signage and transport The pre-bookings are monitored by staff at Ajanta: they get a fair idea of the expected crowd	*Website: www.exploreajanta.com* -The staff has an idea of the expected crowd. -The supporting services like Ajanta visitors' centre, porter services, bus services can be managed better *Interactive devices on rent at the ticket counter* -The staff gives out these devices -The device also tracks visitors' movements within the Caves	*Website: www.exploreajanta.com* -The website enlists the visitors' content for 3 months. -This in a way refreshes information and helps maintain order at the site.

STAKEHOLDERS IN THE SYSTEM



TRIGGERS: CLUES TO LEAD PROSPECTIVE VISITORS TO THE WEBPAGE





ONCE THE VISITORS LANDS ON THE WEBSITE:

www.exploreajanta.com



Welcome to Explore Ajanta



Explore Ajanta

Ajanta | Services | Ajanta Today | Visitors speak | Contact us





History | How to reach | Important Info

The Ajanta Caves in Aurangabad district of Maharashtra, India are about 30 rock-cut Buddhist cave monuments which date from the 2nd century BCE to about 480 or 650 CE. The caves include paintings and sculptures described by the government Archaeological Survey of India as "the finest surviving examples of Indian art, particularly painting",which are masterpieces of Buddhist religious art, with figures of the Buddha and depictions of the Jataka tales.

Explore Ajanta app

DOWNLOAD

Explore Ajanta

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Devices | Bus Shuttle | Ajanta Visitors Center | Light & Sound Show | Porter Services | Amenities



(72)

DOWNLOAD

EXPLORE AJANTA APP

A Location based app for your smartphone



Dapibus, neque id cursus faucibus, tortor neque egestas

Rent : 25/-

Prebook



Dapibus, neque id cursus faucibus, tortor neque egestas

Rent : 100/-

Prebook



Dapibus, neque id cursus faucibus, tortor neque egestas

Rent : 400/-

Prebook

Wish to explore Ajanta on your own? Download our *clue map*

Explore Ajanta



(72)

DOWNLOAD

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Devices | Bus Shuttle | Ajanta Visitors Center | Light & Sound Show | Porter Services | Amenities



The Feel of Ajanta brought to life with lights and serenity of nightlife. Come enjoy the show!

Schedule | Book a seat !

Explore Ajanta

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Devices | Bus Sh



EXPLORE AJANTA APP

A Location based app for



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ebook

Please Register with us.

Name | Date

email id | No of people

Phone no

GO | Reset

Explore Ajanta

Ajanta | Services | Ajanta Today | Visitors speak | Contact us

Devices | Bus Sh

EXPLORE AJANTA APP

A Location based app for

Thank you for registering with us, Amey!

Find your details on YOUR VISIT page

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Devices Booking | Light & Sound Booking

Your visit

Device Booked : Interactive Visual Device

Quantity of Device : 2

For 29th May 2013

Reset

Other Devices at Ajanat



Dapibus, neque id cursus faucibus, tortor neque egestas

Rent : 25/-

Prebook



Dapibus, neque id cursus faucibus, tortor neque egestas

Rent : 100/-

Prebook



Dapibus, neque id cursus faucibus, tortor neque egestas

Rent : 400/-

Prebook

Wish to explore Ajanta on your own? Download our *clue map*



Explore Ajanta

Your visit

Show booked for : 29th May 2013

Number of People : 2

Reset

Other Services at Ajanat

Ajanta Visitors Centre

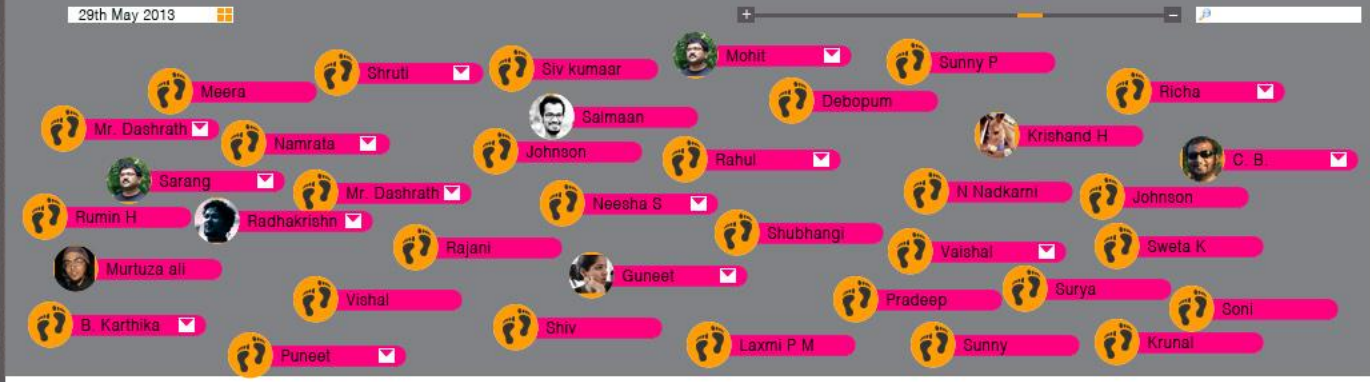
Porter Service

Bus Shuttle Service

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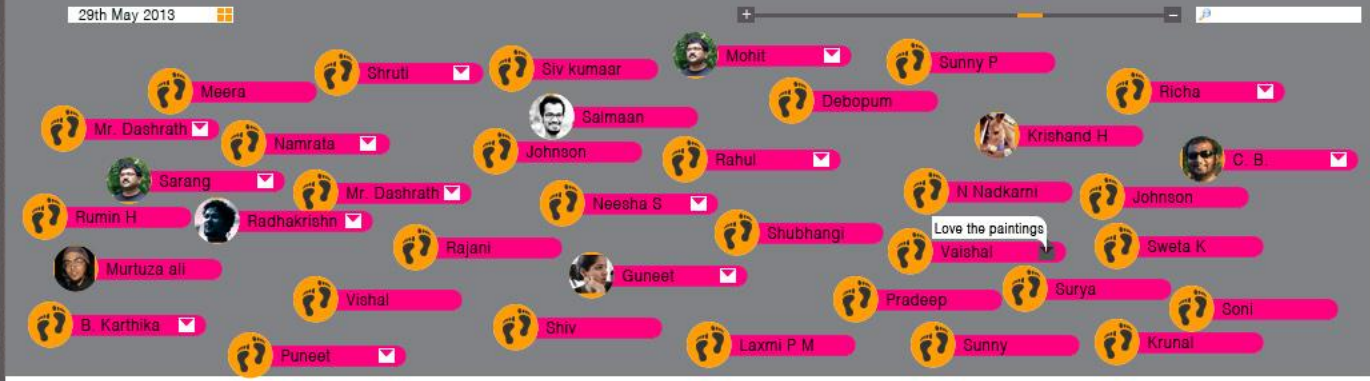
Foot-prints at Ajanta Emo Trail



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Foot-prints at Ajanta Emo Trail



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Foot-prints at Ajanta Emo Trail



You can search for a apecial person's Trail I type name here

Explore Ajanta

Visitor's Forum



TRAVEL
STORY
EXPERIENCE

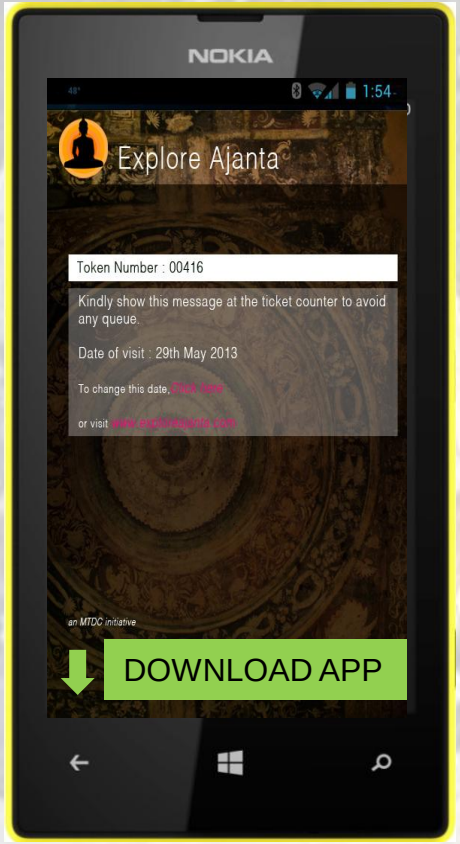
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Tina : Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetuer adipiscing elit. Nam cursus. Morbi ut mieni leo, egestas id, condimentum at, laoreet mattis, massa.

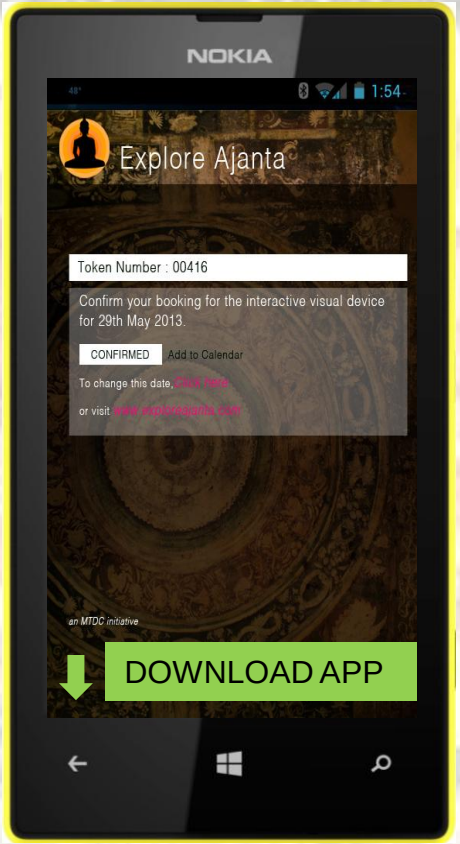
Type

Submit

ARTIFACT FOR VISITOR ON REGISTERING WITH THE SYSTEM**:**



ON THE DAY BEFORE THE VISIT:



AT THE TICKET COUNTER AT AJANTA FOOTHILLS: ONE TICKET FOR THE TRIP

MAHARASTRA TOURISM DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION
For more details visit: www.exploreajanta.com

Amenities Charges: Rs. 10/-



The Explore Ajanta App is now up for download. *

*Charges apply

0836

MSRTC for Ajanta Caves, Fardapur
Rs. 10/-
One Way Bus Ticket

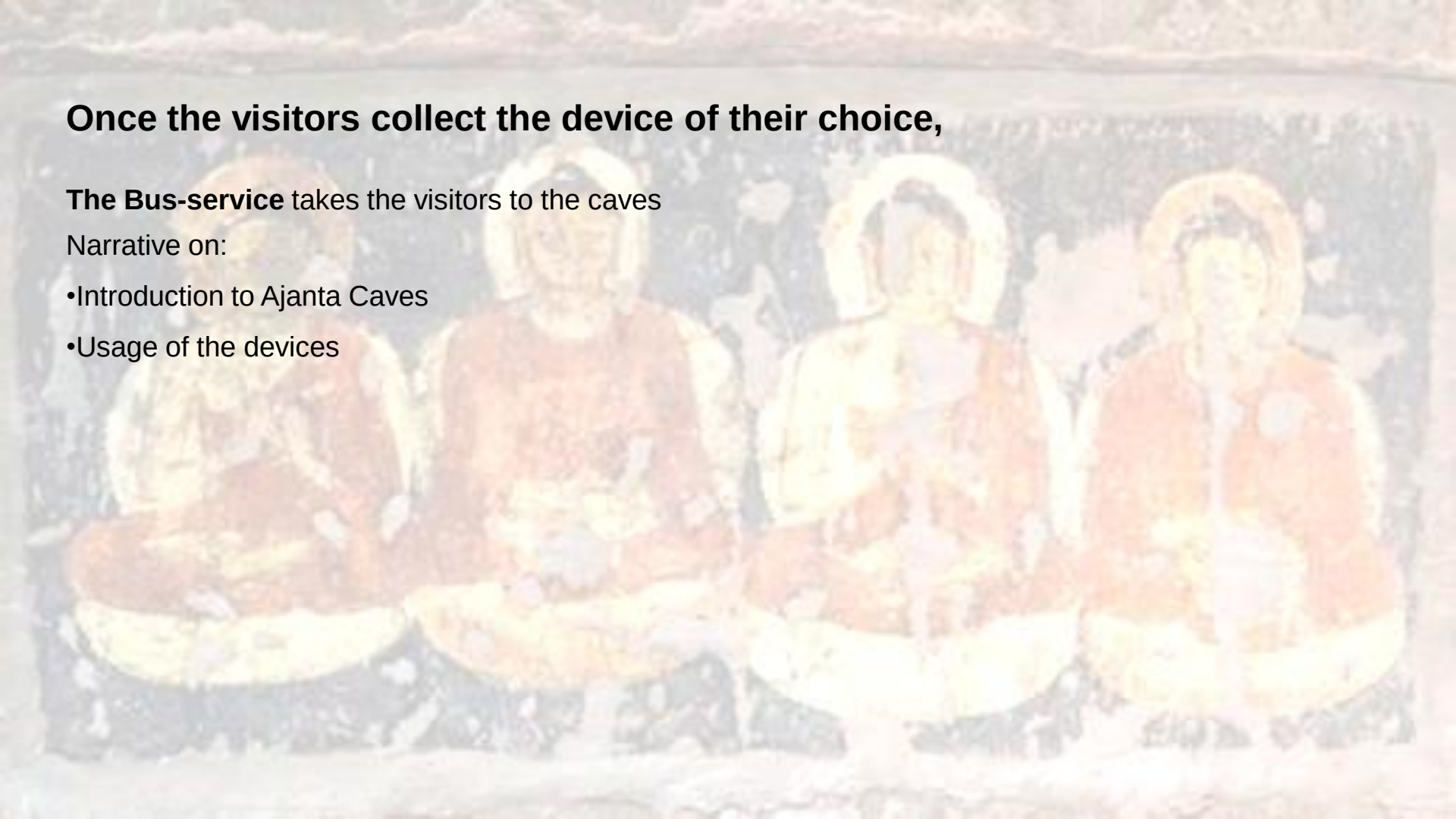
MSRTC for Ajanta Caves, Fardapur
Rs. 10/-
One Way Bus Ticket

Once the visitors collect the device of their choice,

The Bus-service takes the visitors to the caves

Narrative on:

- Introduction to Ajanta Caves
- Usage of the devices



Visitors with Hands-free Audio Device:



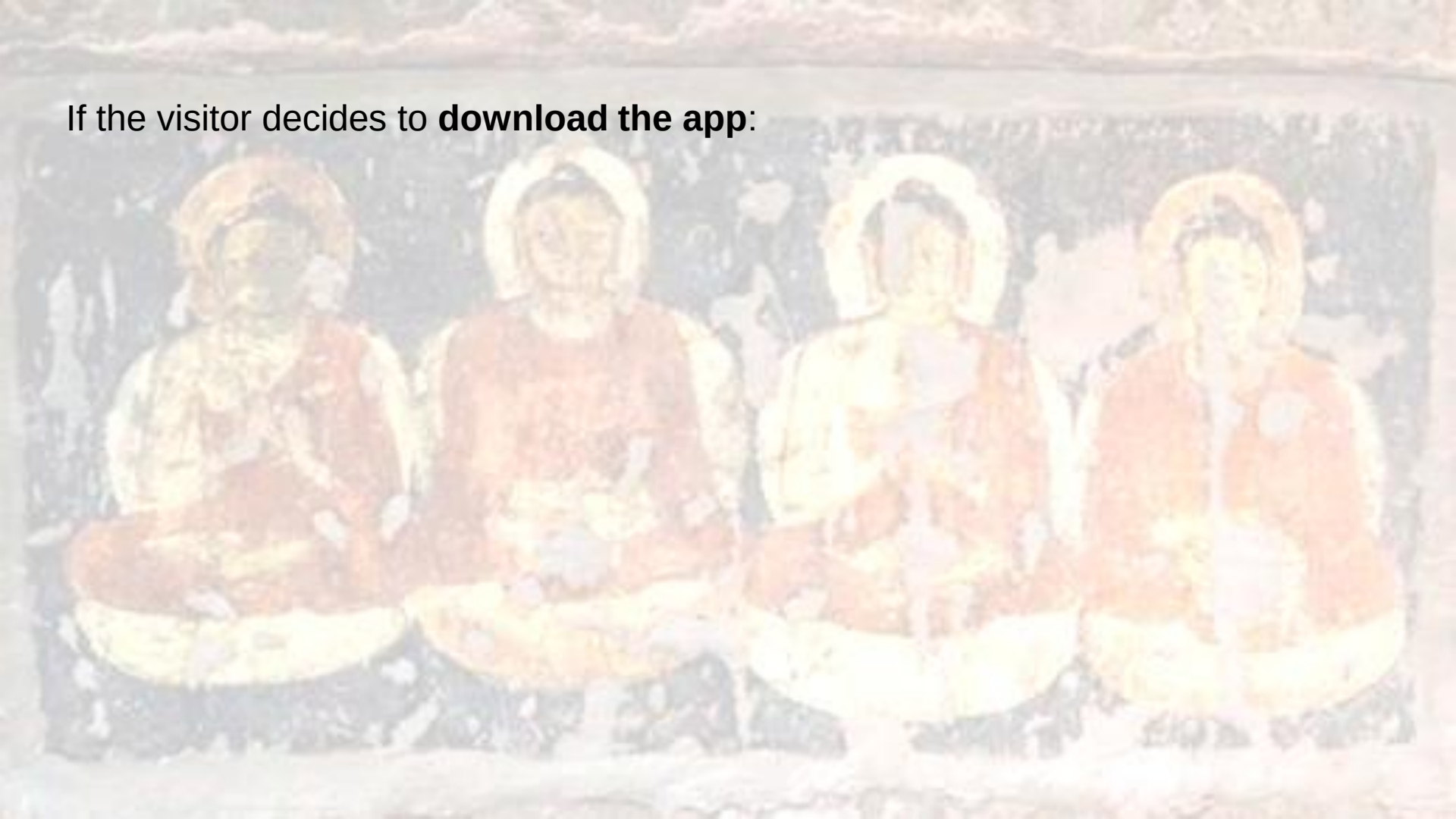
Visitors with Interactive Video Device:



Visitors with Interactive Video Device:

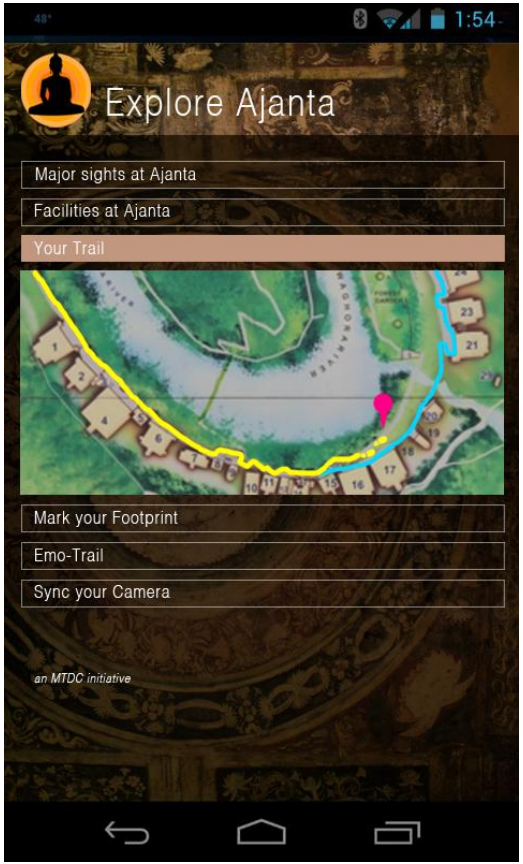


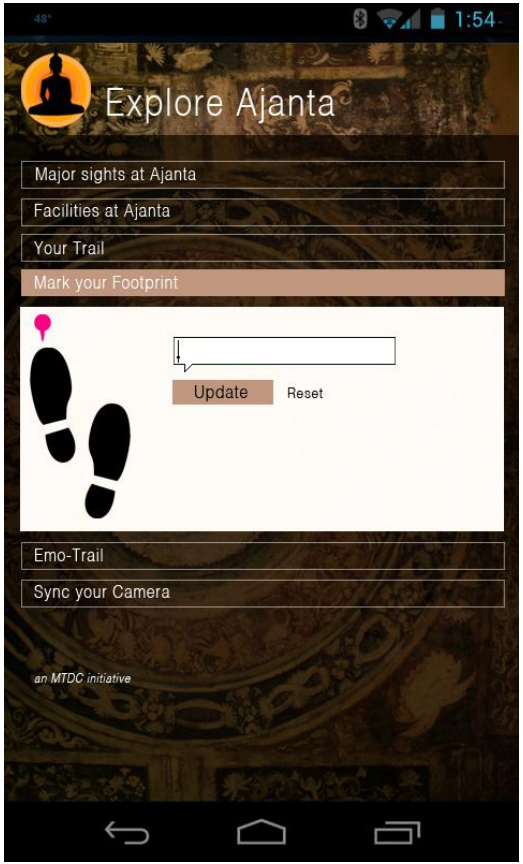
If the visitor decides to **download the app**:

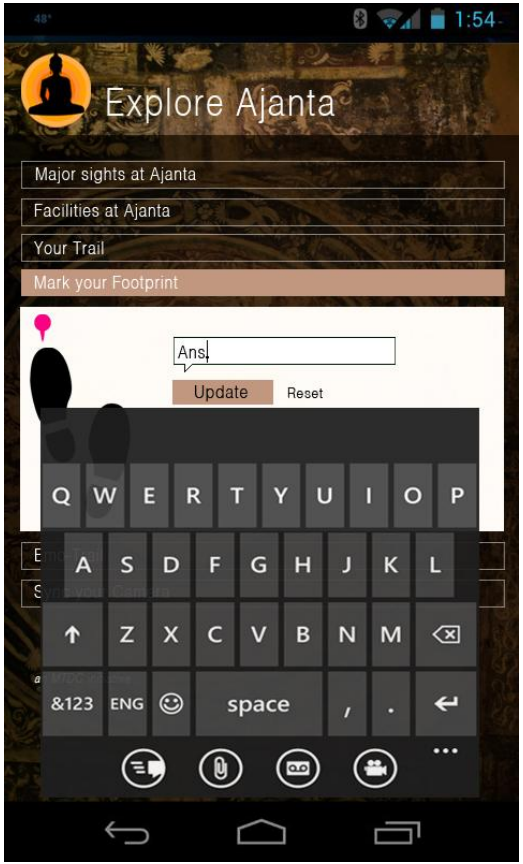



1:54
Explore Ajanta
Major Sight at Ajanta
Facilities at Ajanta
Your Trail
Mark your Footprint
Emo-Trail
Sync your Camera
an MTDC initiative


1:54
Explore Ajanta
Major sights at Ajanta
Facilities at Ajanta
Helpline
Food
Water
Porter
Toilet
Medical Help
Your Trail
Mark your Footprint
Emo-Trail
Sync your Camera
an MTDC initiative


1:54
Explore Ajanta
Major sights at Ajanta
Facilities at Ajanta
Your Trail
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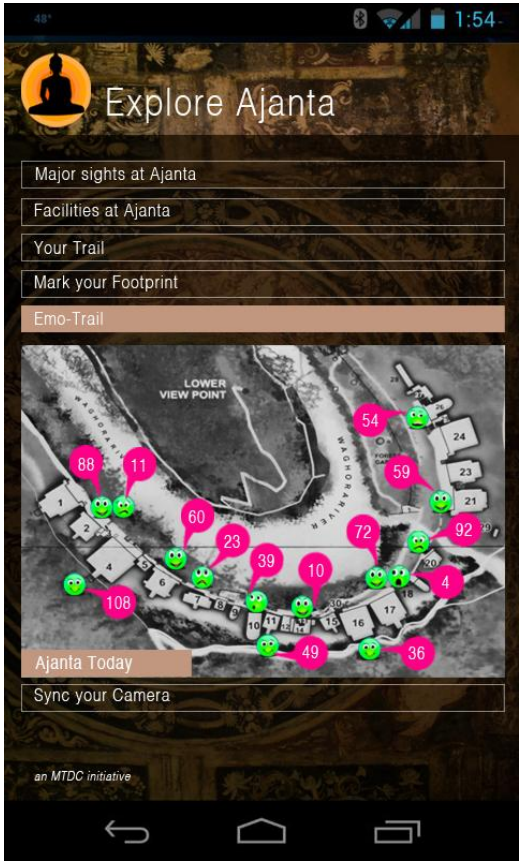

1:54
Explore Ajanta
Major sights at Ajanta
Facilities at Ajanta
Your Trail
Mark your Footprint
Update
Reset
Emo-Trail
Sync your Camera
an MTDC initiative


1:54
Explore Ajanta
Major sights at Ajanta
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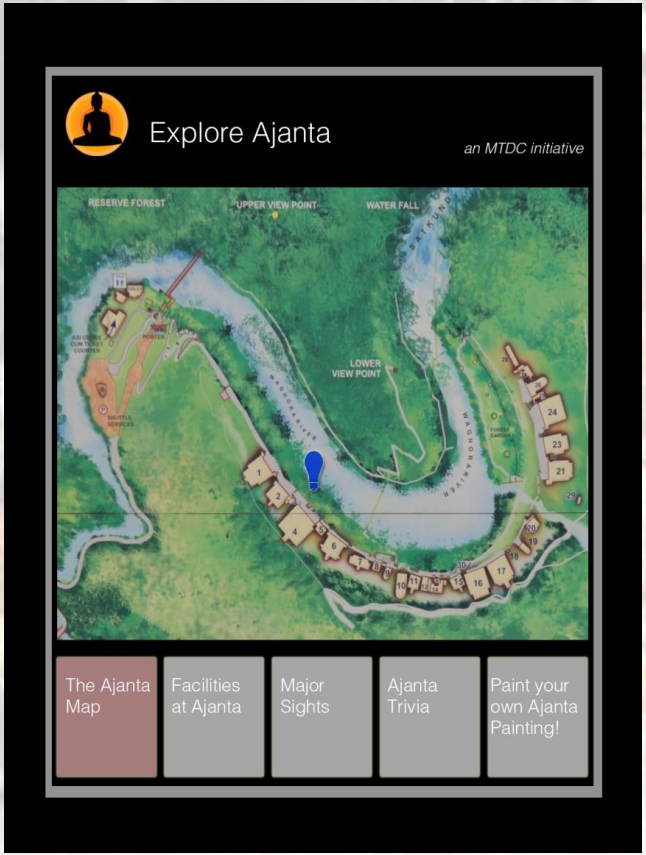

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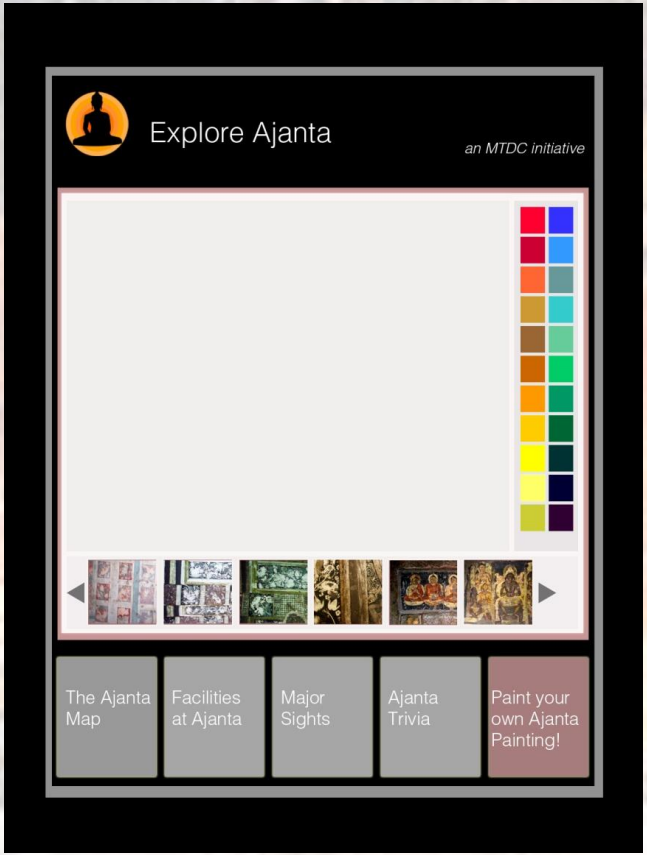

1:54
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Emo-Trail
VIEW POINT
WAGHORA RIVER
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an MTDC initiative


1:54
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LOWER VIEW POINT
WAGHORA RIVER
Ajanta Today
Sync your Camera
an MTDC initiative


1:54
Explore Ajanta
Major sights at Ajanta
Facilities at Ajanta
Your Trail
Mark your Footprint
Emo-Trail
LOWER VIEW POINT
WAGHORA RIVER
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Ajanta Today
Sync your Camera
an MTDC initiative

A visitor without any device, can refer the **Interactive Display Panels**:






Explore Ajanta
The Ajanta Map
Facilities at Ajanta
Major Sights
Ajanta Walks

After the Visit, the visitors can refer to their page on the website:





Welcome to Explore Ajanta



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Devices Booking | Light & Sound Booking | Your Trail | Footprints at Ajanta | Emo Trail

Your visit

Hi, Amey!



To download your Trail, Click Here

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Your visit

Hi, Amey!



To tag yourself to your footprint, paste your weblinks here : Link

To look for other footprints type here : Search

To see footprints of a particular day, choose date :

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Your visit

Hi, Amey!



Choose date, for the emo-trails on that day :

To look for particular visitor's emo-trails type here : Search

TESTING

Testing of the Explore Ajanta App was conducted among 8 subjects who had been to Ajanta earlier.

- Multi-lingual options in the App
- Could not understand ‘Emo-trail’ in the beginning
- ‘If I like to get lost/ explore on my own, how does that fit?’
- Social Media links on the App

Further Development Plan

- IDC, IIT Bombay is developing this project live for the Government of India

I would also like to

- develop this experience further for visitors who would use this service more than once
- To set up a periodic review of the working of this system: to continue or discontinue a service/ device over time
- To integrate details into the workings of the devices once data gets populated into the website.
- To look into other factors that effect experience, like facilities, architectural additions, conservation policies with sustainable tourism



Thank You